

1. Palchick, G. (2026). Agnostic Data Thinking: What You're Allowed to Do to Data (and When You're Lying to Yourself).
2. Rosenberg, D. (2013). Data Before the Fact.

Both texts address the concept of *data*, while Rosenberg situates it by tracing data's semantic shift, Palchik frames data in terms of operability. Rosenberg approaches the data from a historical perspective, he examines its ontological and epistemological status and how data has shifted through time. On the other hand, Palchik focuses on usability of data. His main argument is that most data errors do not come from bad computation, but from illegitimate questions asked to data.

Rosenberg claims that Priestly uses 'data' to refer to experimental measurements of volume. Data is not facts or evidence or truth. When the term 'data' first appeared, it was used to refer to principles accepted as a basis of an argument. Over time, as its meaning shifted, it came to denote empirical facts established through experimentation. Data is something "given" within an argument. Back in these days, data is generally understood as expected assumptions, not a collected thing. Today, data is something collected from the world through measurement, and can be computed. In Palchik's paper, we encountered the question "*Am I allowed to compute this at all?*"; we can see that we always need to approach the data critically. This critical approach is called '*agnostic data thinking*' and it means *deciding before computing*. One needs to understand what the data is and the range of operations it permits. To understand data, we must ask the right questions; data becomes meaningful through the questions that direct and frame them. Even if certain moves are technically executable, that does not make them meaningful. All errors stem from mischaracterizing the nature of the data.

Two papers approach data in different ways: In Rosenberg's paper we see an effort to construct a meaning for *data*, whereas in Palchik's paper we see data in a more stable and technical form, operationally interrogable. Could this situation change in the future? Might data undergo a semantic shift again? If a shift happens, would it still be mentioning 'computing' in the same sense?

In my opinion, one should understand facts and evidence firstly to understand what data is. We can learn rhetorical sides of data from Rosenberg; while learning how to approach data and what to do with it from Palchik. Taken together, they suggest the meaning of data is neither fixed nor purely technical; rather, it remains historically shifted. This indicates that the current computational understanding of data should not be treated as final, maybe it will eventually give way to another conceptual reconfiguration.